

**a** AI Highlight ▾

It's not that I can't access the love, but the love seems unsafe. My inner child is sitting there observing its grown-up self and saying, "Yeah, that doesn't look like things went well for us." Then I find myself getting resentful at the child and saying, "Well, you're the one who was the child and you have the opportunity to grow up." I end up at war with the younger version who didn't do what they were supposed to do, while the older version is trying to make this vow of protection and nurturing. And the child is sitting there thinking, "Big fuckity whoopty doo. What are you gonna do for me?" Relaxation hasn't really affected that awkward, difficult time with the inner child for me.

In my inner-child work I call the adult roles the Nurturer and Protector.

The Protector creates real-world safety. The Protector cleans the room.

I also use gentle self-hypnosis for reparenting and present safety. I do not use it to force trauma memories.

If these adult voices do not feel available yet, I begin as the witness who notices. A neutral witness counts when no parent image feels safe.

